TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

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PREPARING FOR A JOB INTERVIEW

FUNDAMENTALS of a job interview:

- live situation of communication more difficult to experience than writing a CV or a CL;
- needs a lot of preparation due to its complexity:

1. Doing research into the company (history, achievements, values and mission, the profile of the employee);
2. Reviewing the requirements of the position and the application documents (CV and CL);

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3. Anticipating and brainstorming questions and answers (questions ref. to educational background, work experience, hard and soft skills, extra-curricular activities etc);
4. Becoming aware of the importance of nonverbal communication and attitude;
5. Managing one's emotions;
6. Practising mock interviews and asking for feedback;
7. Finding the appropriate outfit.

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ONLINE resources to help you prepare for a job interview:

- Interview Strategies (thebalancemoney.com)
- https://megainterview.com
- Interview Skills | SkillsYouNeed
- www.kent.ac.uk/ces/student/interviews.html
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J_lgyK37JJM

(Robin Ryan, career counselor)

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=si434ZntKOw

(Daniel Hallak, career counselor)

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QUESTIONS frequently asked in a job interview:

1. What are your salary requirements?
2. Why do you want to work as a/an …?
3. What qualifications do you have that make you a good candidate for the job?
4. What is your idea of success?
5. What makes you better suited for this job than the other applicants I've already interviewed?

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6. What are your long-range goals? What do you want to be doing in five years' time?
7. What are your strengths and weaknesses?
8. How did your education prepare you for this job?
9. What is your impression of our firm?
10. Do you prefer working with others or by yourself?

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11. How can I be assured that you are able to make quick decisions?
12. Are you willing to work overtime?
13. What do you plan for your professional development?
14. What kinds of decisions are most difficult for you?
15. How would you describe your personality?

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16. Why should we hire you for this position?
17. How does your experience relate to this job?
18. What are your most relevant academic accomplishments?
19. What are the main things you have learned from your work/project experience?
20. Have you taken any additional training courses?

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ANSWERING the FAQ in a job interview:

- Know the job description and requirements very well;
- Make your answers as **SPECIFIC**, **RELEVANT** and **CLEAR** as possible.

1. Q about **salary**: know the range within which the payment for your position is placed/ the payment should reflect/be commensurate with the candidate's skills, qualifications and experience.
2. Q about the **reason for applying** for the position X: a. passion for/interest in the domain the position pertains; b. the candidate knows the company's strengths/values/mission; c. the candidate has the qualifications/skills/personal qualities that make them suitable for the job.

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3. Q about the **qualifications** for the position X: the candidate speaks about their educational background, their specific skills and experience that correspond to the job requirements.
4. Q about **short-term and long-term goals**/5 years' time: the candidate (if an undergraduate student) speaks about: expected graduation (year), plans to continue their education (MS in a given domain), start working/develop a career in X, eventually start their own business.

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5. Q about **strengths** and **weaknesses**:

The candidate names the strengths that relate to the position and gives evidence in support of them (descriptions, examples from past experience/situations that illustrate the strengths and their effects on the candidate's work performance/ interpersonal relations.

The candidate specifies the weakness(es) and a compensation for it/ them/ a strategy they use to decrease the potential negative effect of the weakness(es) (e.g. the candidate lacks work experience, but is a motivated quick learner, which compensates for the weakness).

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6. Q about **education**: the candidate speaks about their educational background and the specific sets of skills developed (hard and soft) that they bring to the job.
7. Q about the candidate's **knowledge/impression of the company**: the candidate should know as much as possible about the company (through personal research before the interview).
8. Q about **independent** vs **team work**: the candidate can prefer one to the other one, but should handle both, being aware of the advantages and disadvantages of each.

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9. Q about **making decisions**: a. the candidate may use an example from past experince; b. the candidate may speak about a hypothetical situation and the possible consequences of their decision.
10. Q about **experience** (employment/project): the candidate specifies the position/project in which they got experience and the responsibilities/tasks/actions they took, the technologies/tools they used, the results obtained and what they have learnt from that experience.

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11. Q about **personality**: the candidate specifies their most valuable personal qualities (character adjectives illustrating personality traits) that are relevant to the position and explains how those qualities may impact their work performance and relationships.
12. Q about **academic accomplishments**: the candidate may speak about: a. past achievements (honours and awards section in the CV: contests, competitions); b. future achievements as goals to reach (getting their BS, MS or PhD).

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13. Q about **the reason for hiring** the candidate: the candidate points out they have the necessary qualifications and skills and their personal qualities and attitude towards the job make them stand out.
14. Q about **additional training**: the candidate mentions any other courses they have attended and which have provided them with specific skills or abilities relevant to the position (or **transferable** skills from one field to another).

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- **Thank you note/letter** e-mailed or handwritten to be sent to the interviewer/s **after** the interview (within 24h):

1. Subject line: *Thank you for the interview*
2. Greeting: *Dear* + *Mr/Mrs/Ms Name of the interviewer*
3. Expression of gratitude: *Thank you for the opportunity to discuss the X position with me.*

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4. Reiteration of the candidate's qualifications for the post: *My 5+ years of experience in digital marketing and exceptional presentation skills make me a strong candidate for this role.*

5. Prompting the interviewer to take the next step: *I would be pleased to attend a follow-up interview regarding my candidacy for this position.*

6. Contact info: *candidate's e-mail and phone no.*

To do for Seminar 3

- With the help of www.thebalancecareers.com or https://megainterview.com (or any other reliable source available to you), answer the 20 questions proposed in relation to the job ad for which you have written your CV and CL.

Bibliography

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- https://megainterview.com
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J_lgyK37JJM (Robin Ryan, career counselor)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=si434ZntKOw (Daniel Hallak, career counselor)